

First open source supercomputer, Parallella, shares its source code

One thing we all know is that the world of open source software is vast and varied. Think of any software and you can easily find a FOSS alternative! But we wonder if the same is true with open source hardware. A while back, a new hardware project inspired by Raspberry Pi and Arduino, called the Parallella project, was kick-started with the promise to create a cheap, reliable supercomputer for all, and the team behind it promised that they would use open source hardware. The project campaign has now come to an end and the group has successfully fulfilled its promise by publishing the hardware sources for the first version of the Parallella board on Github.

The most astonishing feature of the device is that in spite of being a powerful computer, the whole system consumes just 5 watts of electricity. Based on the reports, while in use, the 64-core version of Parallella provides enough processing power to compete with a 45 GHz CPU.

Now, a Linux pen that does a spell-check, improves handwriting

Have you ever wanted a pen that could tell you about your spelling mistakes just like the word processor on your computer? Presenting Lernstift — (German for ‘learning pen’) a Linux-based smart pen that helps users correct spelling mistakes and improve their handwriting as well.

Though there are other smart pens on the market like Livescribe, Lernstift is extraordinary because it doesn’t need special paper and allows you to change pen tips—including a fountain pen module, a ballpoint module, and also a pencil module. You can pre-order the gadget through Kickstarter and expect it by December this year.

in mind and its rock-solid performance makes remote device monitoring straightforward and dependable.

Now, convert household objects into drones

Drones are known as outstanding machines that fly with a level of accuracy and silence—a characteristic that makes them both beautiful as well as dangerous. A Dutch independent artist and programming hobbyist, Jasper Van Loenen, has designed a thin, stainless-steel briefcase that can fly any household item with just a few turns of the screw. The ‘Drone It Yourself’ kit introduced by Loenen comprises four motors and a CPU control kit that can be fixed on any household object, and then it has the ability to fly like an Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV).

The kit was designed using a 3D printer and contains a small bill of materials. The ‘Drone It Yourself’ system runs on an OpenPilot flight controller, which makes the entire kit completely open source and free. You need not use soldering or heavy machinery to create the components listed. Also, no technical knowhow is needed to implement it. The kit is based on a simple vice mechanism and can work with anything that it can grab. As a result, you get flying objects of all shapes and sizes, but with differing flight complexity.



A Raspberry Pi-powered robot that will make your coffee

Now scientists in Japan have made it possible for you to have a personal robot to do what you tell it to—like getting you that cup of coffee. Christened Rapiro, this is a humanoid robot which can be programmed to carry out various commands.

The kit itself was first created by a Japanese company to function as a “... catalyst between robotics and Raspberry Pi.” The robot is the size of an average credit-card and works on Raspberry Pi.

Users can program it to carry out various tasks including managing a personal calendar, keeping track of the weather and, of course, making coffee.

Interestingly, it is easy for potential buyers to customise the offering based on their requirements. However, one would have to be familiar with the technology, which is pretty advanced.



Microsoft to open source WCF RIA Services

Microsoft will be handing over its WCF RIA Services to the Outercurve Foundation as an open source project. This service will help in developing n-tier solutions for Rich Internet Applications (RIA), specifically those that employ Microsoft’s Silverlight. Originally founded by Microsoft, the open source organisation will manage Open RIA Services as part of its ASP.NET Open Source Gallery. This gallery is already home to various projects including NuGet, Orchard, DotNetOpenAuth and xUnit.net.

Microsoft has been working on the transfer process for some time and aims to complete the process by this summer. A website has already been created on Codeplex, which is a hosting platform for open source projects by